

Comparison Image Field Guide: Suckers and After Bud Break

The 13 real reference photographs needed for the new research on rootstock suckers and on removing dead, damaged or diseased wood after bud break — with what to shoot, how to frame it, and the AI-generated placeholder standing in for each one.

How to use this in the field

1. Each entry shows a Tag ID, what the photo needs to demonstrate, how to frame it, and the rose and season it needs.
2. The image on each card is an AI-generated placeholder, not a real photo — it shows roughly what's needed, not something to match exactly.
3. When you get a real photo, save it as that entry's Tag ID (e.g. IMG-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-01.jpg) and pass it back so it can replace the placeholder.
4. Read the highlighted notes before shooting — they flag a real gap or caveat in the research.
5. Sucker photos are for teaching what to look for on the plant. Pip never decides a shoot is a sucker from a photo alone.

Source: Ask Pip – Comparison Image Sourcing Brief: Rootstock Suckers and Removal After Bud Break, v0.1 (29 September 2026), drawn from ARC-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-01 and ARC-BUSHROSE-POSTBUDBREAK-01. Nothing here is new content. Placeholders: OpenArt GPT Image 2.5 Sunburst, 29 September 2026.

1. Rootstock Suckers

New observation (PKR-OBS-000007). Where the shoot starts is the deciding check — the other signs only help in the growing season.

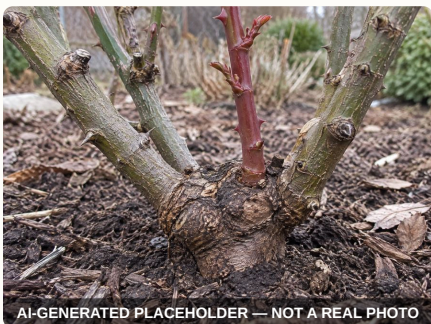


IMG-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-01

1.1 Sucker starting below a visible bud union (positive example)

- What to show A shoot that starts below the knobbly bud union: a sucker.
- Framing Ground level; the bud union and the exact point where the shoot starts both sharp in one frame.
- Rose & season Grafted Hybrid Tea, Floribunda or Grandiflora; dormant season preferred.

Easily confused with the rose's own new cane — shoot SUCKERS-02 with matching framing.



IMG-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-02

1.2 The rose's own basal cane (lookalike to keep)

- What to show A new cane starting at or just above the union — the rose's own, and valuable.
- Framing Same framing as SUCKERS-01, for a side-by-side comparison.
- Rose & season As SUCKERS-01.

Don't rely on shoot colour — sources disagree on whether red new growth means the rose's own cane.



IMG-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-03

1.3 Sucker traced under the soil

- What to show A sucker that starts below ground, traced by clearing soil back to its root below the union.
- Framing From slightly above, soil cleared, bud union in frame for reference.
- Rose & season Grafted bush rose, any season.

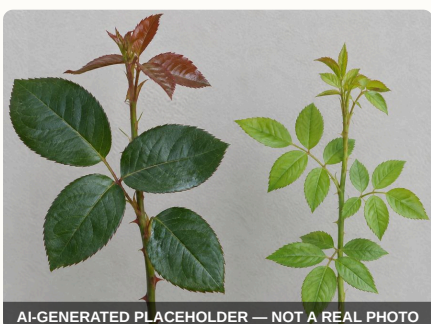


IMG-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-04

1.4 Bud union not visible

- What to show Canes going straight into the soil with no knot visible — the case where Pip won't call anything a sucker.
- Framing Ground level, same framing as SUCKERS-01.
- Rose & season Bush rose, dormant.

A photo can't tell a buried union from a rose on its own roots.



IMG-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-05

1.5 Sucker leaves beside the rose's own leaves

- What to show Sucker leaves are often paler, smaller, or have a different number of leaflets.
- Framing Side by side, same scale, neutral background.
- Rose & season Growing season only.

Supporting sign only, never used alone — the "seven leaflets" rule isn't reliable.



IMG-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-06

1.6 Sucker flowers beside the rose's own flowers

What to show Sucker flowers differ — often small, single, white or dark red.
Framing Both kinds of flower in one frame, on the same bush.
Rose & season Flowering season only.

Supporting sign only.

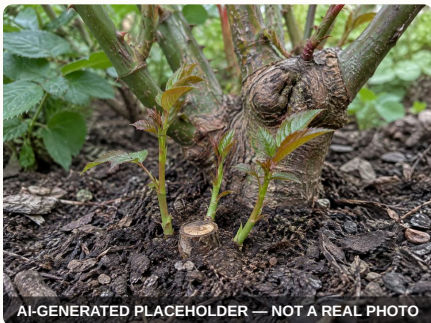


IMG-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-07

1.7 Removing a sucker at its origin (technique)

What to show Gloved hands pulling a sucker away right where it starts, below the union.
Framing Close-up of hands at the exposed origin.
Rose & season Grafted bush rose, any season.

Sources disagree on tearing versus a clean cut at the origin; this shows tearing.



IMG-BUSHROSE-SUCKERS-08

1.8 What not to do: cut at soil level

What to show A sucker stub cut at the surface, with regrowth around it.
Framing Soil level, stub and new shoots in focus.
Rose & season Grafted bush rose, growing season.

2. Dormancy and Removal After Bud Break

The dormancy question (PKR-SGT-000001 v1.1) now decides between full pruning and removing only dead, damaged or diseased wood.



IMG-BUSHROSE-POSTBUDBREAK-01

2.1 Still dormant: buds tight or just swelling

What to show Buds tight and closed, or just beginning to swell; no leaves open.
Framing Macro of a cane section with several buds.
Rose & season Established bush rose, late winter.

In mild climates judge by the buds, not whether leaves have dropped.



IMG-BUSHROSE-POSTBUDBREAK-02

2.2 Active growth well underway

What to show Opened leaves and clearly growing shoots on every cane.
Framing Whole bush, base to tips.
Rose & season Established bush rose, spring.

The placeholder shows the rose in full flower — a real photo should show earlier growth, before flowering.



IMG-BUSHROSE-POSTBUDBREAK-03

2.3 Dead cane on a rose already in leaf

What to show One dry, leafless cane among leafy green ones — what the removal-only session is for.
Framing Whole bush, dead cane clearly visible.
Rose & season Established bush rose in full leaf.

Only a cut showing the pith confirms dead wood.

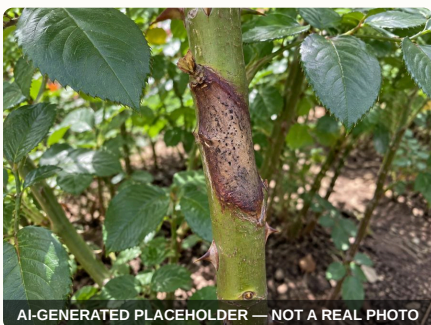


IMG-BUSHROSE-POSTBUDBREAK-04

2.4 Frost dieback after growth has begun

What to show Young shoot tips browned or blackened by a late frost, green below.
Framing Close enough to show damaged tips against green growth.
Rose & season Established bush rose, early spring after a frost.

The full extent of frost damage often doesn't show straight away.



IMG-BUSHROSE-POSTBUDBREAK-05

2.5 Canker on a rose in leaf

What to show A sunken purplish-brown patch with tiny black dots on a leafy cane.
Framing Close-up of the lesion, healthy cane below, leaves in frame.
Rose & season Established bush rose, growing season.

Experts differ on diagnosing canker from a photo.